

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The patient's history of feeling sad for as long as he can remember, feeling hopeless, and having difficulty making decisions are consistent with a long-term history of depression. The worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, and current symptoms of energy and concentration issues suggest a recent depressive episode. The patient's previous history of depression combined with the current depressive episode fits the description of double depression, which is a recurrence of depression in an individual with a prior history of depression. Mania or psychosis would present with different symptoms, anhedonia is a common symptom in depression, and paranoid personality disorder is characterized by distrust and suspiciousness.

</think>

<answer> A. The patient is at risk for double depression. </answer>

